



ShabbaTTogether

Shalom Zone Guide for Ages 5-12

Goal: To create a quiet/calm down space in your home for all ages to use to help regulate strong emotions in a healthy way.

Target Audience: Children ages 5-12

Time: Approximately 1 hour to create or more if you want to be creative

Medium: @Home project

Note to Parents

Dear Parents,

This information is for you on how to create a Shalom Zone together with your child in your home. Included are items to print, color and hang, items to purchase or make on your own, and different tools to help make your Shalom Zone a useful tool for your needs.

Enjoy!

What is a Shalom Zone?

Sometimes winding down can be hard for kids, especially with all of the distractions around like games, siblings, TV, internet, etc. Creating a quiet corner or a reading nook can give children a wonderful opportunity to find calm (and you too!).

The Shalom Zone is a safe space for kids to go when they need help self-regulating or calming their bodies and emotions. It is meant to be a place for them to relax, recharge, or release their pent-up anger or frustration.

Picking The Right Space For The Shalom Zone

Try to pick one space in your home for your child's Shalom Zone area so that they know exactly where to go when they need it.

It should be away from distractions and can really be anywhere you want: in your child's bedroom, in the basement, under the stairs, in a closet, in a corner of a room — wherever you think your child will be the most comfortable!

When To Use The Shalom Zone

The Shalom Zone space should feel welcoming and inviting to your child. Please keep in mind however, it is not designed as a place to send your child for punishment or a time-out so do not force them to use the space in that way.

You can use the calm Shalom Zone right after school or before bed to help kids unwind and decompress after a long day. Retreating to a calm down space is perfect for when your child is angry, frustrated, anxious, or overwhelmed. It can also help when they are having a tantrum or meltdown.

Introduce the Shalom Zone to your child prior to using it, when they are calm and relaxed. Let them know that it is their special place to go when they need some time to themselves and that you may remind them of their special Shalom Zone when they seem to need it.

Watch your child's body and behaviour for signs that they might be overwhelmed and need a break. If you can see that your child is struggling to self-regulate, then simply validate their feelings and emotions and suggest that they enjoy some quiet time in their Shalom Zone. You can also suggest sitting with them and reading a book or sitting together as a way to invite them into their assigned space.

What To Include In Your Shalom Zone

When it comes to deciding what to include in your child's Shalom Zone, try to involve them in the decisions so they feel ownership over their space. Since each child is different, consider your child's interests when setting up the space. Use objects that your child finds comforting, engaging, and calming. Keep items age appropriate and ask older children to be more involved in helping to create the space.

Here are some examples of items to consider including in your Shalom Zone:

- Printable Signs to Print and Hang:
 - ○ A [“My Shalom Zone”](#) sign that your child designs and can hang in their space
 - Emotional Regulation Chart - [What Zone Am I In?](#)
- A comfy place to sit like a bean bag, some pillows, or a play tent
- A journal to document your journey or get out your emotions
- A sketchbook to express your feelings or relax through art
- Lego
- [Fidget toys to spin, twist and manipulate](#)
- Art supplies and/or sticker books
- [Weighted Blanket](#)
- Puzzles
- [One Person card games](#)
- Noise-reducing headphones to block out sounds that are overwhelming
- [Chewy jewelry and toys](#)
- Stress balls to squeeze or [make your own!](#)
- A favorite stuffed animal to hug
- [Something visual like a sensory bottle, kaleidoscope or lava lamp](#) or [make your own!](#)
- Engaging one-person activities like activity books, individual board games, building blocks, drawing books or magnet tiles.



ShabbaTTogether

Shalom Zone Guide for Teens

Goal: To create a quiet/calm down space in your home for you to use to help regulate strong emotions in a healthy way.

Target Audience: Teens ages 13-18

Time: Approximately 1 hour to create or more if you want to be creative

Medium: @Home project

Note:

You are presented with tons of new experiences and expectations all the time. It can be hard to have a lot of expectations placed on you at school and not feel stressed at times. Life can sometimes feel overwhelming and it can be helpful to have a quiet place to unwind.

What is a Shalom Zone?

Sometimes winding down can be hard, especially with all of the distractions around like school, friends, parents, siblings, TV, internet, etc. Creating a quiet corner or a reading nook can give you a wonderful opportunity to find calm.

The Shalom Zone can be your safe space to go when you need help calming your body, taking a brain break, want to get a handle on your emotions, or just need some alone time. It is meant to be a place for you to relax, recharge, or even release your pent-up anger or frustration.

Picking The Right Space For The Shalom Zone

Talk to your parent and see if they have any ideas for where and how you could make a quiet space. Then work with your parent to try to pick one space in your house or apartment for your Shalom Zone area so that you can have one designated space. It should be away from distractions and can be really anywhere you want: in your bedroom, in the basement, under the stairs, in a closet, in a corner of a room — wherever you think you will be the most comfortable!

When To Use The Shalom Zone

The Shalom Zone space should feel welcoming and inviting to you. This is not a place for you to feel punished or isolated, rather a special place that you can feel safe to work out emotions, take a break and/or calm yourself down.

You can use the Shalom Zone right after school or before bed to help unwind and decompress after a long day. You can also use it when you feel frustrated, sad, angry, or any time your emotions feel intense.

What To Include In Your Shalom Zone

Do you have some comforting things that would make a calm space for you? If you are feeling really creative you can check out Pinterest or check out *Quiet Spaces* online for ideas that use things around the house to make a cool area. You can also visit a thrift store, Dollar Store, or Amazon if you want to decorate your space.

It can also be helpful to consider having a poster with reminders on how you like to calm down, calming stretches or exercises, motivational phrases or pictures, or different emotions you may be feeling. This is not a space to be on your phone with friends, or play video games - as tempting as it may be. This is a space to take time to reduce distractions and sensory input and focus on those that can calm you outside of technology.

- Here are some examples of items to consider including in your Shalom Zone: ● Printable Signs to Hang:
 - ○ A [“My Shalom Zone”](#) sign that your child designs and can hang in their space
 - ○ Emotional Regulation Chart - [What Zone Am I In?](#)
 - ○ [10 Steps to Calm Down](#)
 - ○ [“Shalom Zone” Exercises](#)
 - ○ [“Shalom Zone” Motivational Phrases](#)
 - ○ [“Shalom Zone” Emotions](#)
- A comfy place to sit like a bean bag chair, some pillows, or big chair
- A journal to document your journey or get out your emotions
- A sketchbook to express your feelings or relax through art
- Lego, playdough/clay, or some fun toy that you may still like to play with
- [Fidget toys to spin, twist and manipulate](#)
- Art supplies and/or sticker books
- [Weighted Blanket](#)
- Puzzles
- [One Person card games](#)
- Noise-reducing headphones to block out sounds that are overwhelming
- [Chewy jewelry and toys](#)
- Stress balls to squeeze or [make your own!](#)
- A favorite stuffed animal to hug
- [Something visual like a sensory bottle, kaleidoscope or lava lamp](#) or [make your own!](#)
- Engaging one-person activities like activity books, individual board games, building blocks, drawing books or magnet tiles.



Shalom Zone Guide for Young Adults

Goal: To create a quiet/calm down space in your home for you to use to help regulate strong emotions in a healthy way.

Target Audience: Young Adults ages 18+

Time: Approximately 1 hour to create or more if you want to be creative

Medium: @Home project

Note: With all that is going on in the lives of young adults, it is very helpful to have a relaxation space where you are able to reduce overwhelming feelings. By reducing the sensory overload of the day, like noise, social interactions, work, visual input, and auditory stimulation, you can reduce the emotional overload that can come along with typical stressors of the day.

What is a Shalom Zone?

The Shalom Zone is a safe space for you to go when you need help self-regulating or calming your body and emotions. It is meant to be a place for you to relax, recharge or even release your pent-up anger or frustration.

Picking The Right Space For The Shalom Zone

Try to pick one space in your house or apartment for the Shalom Zone area so that you know exactly where to go when you need it.

It should be away from distractions and can be really anywhere you want: in your bedroom, in the basement, under the stairs, in a closet, in a corner of a room — wherever you think you will be the most comfortable!

When To Use The Shalom Zone

The Shalom Zone space should feel welcoming and inviting. Use the calm Shalom Zone right after school/work, or before bed to help decompress after a long day. It's a great way to avoid having an attitude or showing anger towards others. Retreating to a calm down space is perfect for when you are feeling angry, frustrated, anxious, or overwhelmed.

Watch your body and behaviour for signs that you might be overwhelmed and need a break.

What To Include In Your Shalom Zone

- Here are some examples of items to consider including in your Shalom Zone: ● Printable Signs to Hang:
 - ○ A [“My Shalom Zone”](#) sign that your child designs and can hang in their space
 - ○ Emotional Regulation Chart - [What Zone Am I In?](#)
 - ○ [10 Steps to Calm Down](#)
 - ○ [“Shalom Zone” Exercises](#)
 - ○ [“Shalom Zone” Motivational Phrases](#)
 - ○ [“Shalom Zone” Emotions](#)
- A comfy place to sit like a bean bag chair, some pillows, or big chair
- A journal to document your journey or get out your emotions
- A sketchbook to express your feelings or relax through art
- Lego, playdough/clay, or some fun toy that you may still like to play with
- [Fidget toys to spin, twist and manipulate](#)
- Art supplies and/or sticker books
- [Weighted Blanket](#)
- Puzzles
- [One Person card games](#)
- Noise-reducing headphones to block out sounds that are overwhelming
- [Chewy jewelry and toys](#)
- Stress balls to squeeze or [make your own](#)
- [Yoga poses for relaxation](#)
- [Resistance Bands](#)
- [Weighted Blanket](#)
- Knitting supplies
- Audio books
- A favourite stuffed animal to hug
- Something visual like a kaleidoscope, lava lamp, little lights or [make your own!](#)
- Engaging one-person activities like activity books, individual board games, crosswords, sudoku, or drawing books.